

Q Does that mean Intel has something to offer to all developers, be it a small start-up or a large set-up?

I certainly hope so. I am working with companies that comprise just five people, all the way to the equity investments stage. I hope this is covering a majority of developers. In the process, maybe we will learn that we are missing out on a few and find out what else can be done. Our fundamental approach and strategy is to drive new usages which are relevant to our environment on a variety of hardware platforms. So if there is something that is helpful for a teacher to help students learn the variables of an equation faster, we would love to bring that into the market place. If there is some application that helps businesses to balance their books faster, especially relevant to the Indian environment, we would love to support that. Our objective is to get more and more folks to build applications, not necessarily for Indian environments but preferably for Indian users.

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Q How does a developer contact you to participate in your initiatives?

There are several mechanisms for that. First of all, get online. That is where Intel's developers' zone comes into the scene. This is something which we have re-launched, simplified and tried to make into a simple, focused office. If you want to know what Intel is doing for developers, go to software.intel.com. You can be a part of Intel's developer zone depending upon your interests, technology, etc. If you feel the need to get more benefits, you can contact our partner programme. We have contests available for different parts of the country. My team was a part of around 20-30 events in the past three months -- many of them are hosted by the industry and a few of them are hosted by Intel, and we invite the developers. There is a constant flow of developers coming to us and seeking help in various ways. People use the social media like Facebook pages, Twitter, emails, and catch up at events. We also make a conscious effort to go out and talk to people doing incubation for developers. There are many companies that host events for developers and we are present on such occasions.

Q What are your strategies to involve students from colleges?

We have had a relatively robust programme in academia, fundamentally to build awareness of what is happening in the industry and what students can draw from that -- for instance, our science contests are pretty famous. We work with curriculum bodies and colleges directly. We provide them hardware tips. Some years ago, we went to colleges and spoke to students about multi-core or parallelism in technology, and wanted to get these concepts introduced into their curriculum. It was too early and people were not aware about something like this at all. Today, we can see multi-core smartphones and devices, and they are being advertised for parallelism in computing. We went around and gave curriculum we developed to over 200 colleges across the country at that time.

We are doing a lot with the embedded community on how to build embedded applications. There are some planned efforts and then there are some impromptu initiatives as well, to make the student community benefit from our technology and programmes.

Clover Trail: Intel's controversial child!

Q Let's touch upon the most controversial Intel product being talked about these days, Clover Trail. Does it support Linux and Android?

To begin with, we are working to bring Windows 8. From the tablet platform perspective, our focus was to bring out the platform with the Windows 8 experience. But more and more evolution is scheduled to happen in the coming days. We will bring support for other platforms depending upon the need and demand. For over 15 years, we have always first come out with platforms, and then, over time, added Linux drivers, Linux interfaces and so on. The important thing now, from a consumption perspective, is to look at what kind of trends show up. We have to see whether people are choosing the Windows 8 offering or going down the path of the Android eco-system. We have got the expertise. We have more open source talent than probably any other company. We have got the platforms. I think it is going to be market driven as well. But, for now, Clover Trail is coming with Windows 8.

Q Some reports claim that Intel has ruled out the possibility of any open source technology on Clover Trail.

Clover Trail is an Intel Atom SoC platform in the tablet space. Like other products at Intel, there is a roadmap on the Atom SoC platform, where we will see support for open source technology. When will that happen, I cannot comment right now, but it is surely coming. We will have to see how the market dynamics change. At the same time, form factor also plays a major role on how the platform will evolve. **END** 